

DELHI | Getting a Raw Deal

While the rest of the nation's security apparatus is on high alert for cross-border mischief, senior Research and Analysis Wing (R&AW) brass have been on holiday. In an act unprecedented for any spy agency, six additional secretaries of the R&AW have been on leave for over two months now. The officials, who head various important desks in the external intelligence agency, are ostensibly protesting the appointment of IPS official A.B. Mathur as special secretary, a post just below that of the R&AW chief.

Mathur's lateral induction from the Intelligence Bureau (IB) where he served earlier has effectively ended the chances of these six officers from the in-house Research Analyses Service (RAS) cadre of succeeding present chief K.C. Verma when he retires two years hence. Verma, a 1971 batch IPS officer, served in the IB and Home Ministry before being brought in over the heads of the three seniormost RAS cadre to head RAW earlier this year.



THE R&AW HEADQUARTERS IN DELHI

The grapevine has it that Mathur's induction is another move by the powerful IPS lobby to scupper the chances of another generation of RAS officials. Two of the striking officers have since rejoined after being promoted but four additional secretaries continue to be on protest leave, further adding to the already overflowing cup of woe at India's severely troubled intelligence agency.

by Sandeep Unnithan

CHANDIGARH | New Stick

Taking a cue from the Indian Premier League, Deputy Chief Minister Sukhbir Badal wants to revive traditional Punjab games such as hockey and kabaddi. He says that Punjab will soon start a World Kabaddi League with a prize money of Rs 1 crore. By "reviving" hockey, Badal may be eyeing plum posts in the upcoming Hockey India elections.

by Arvind Chhabra



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